

Certificate import for Windows to install ALPS Visio Plugin

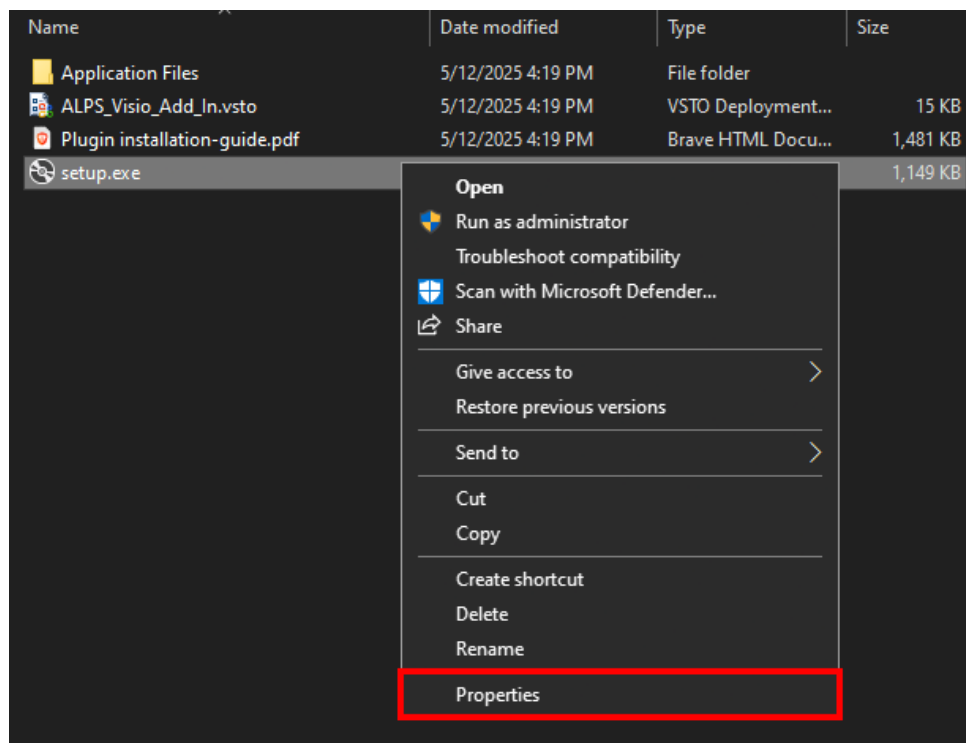
Matthes Elstermann, Lukas Gnad

Read before installation

The ALPS-Visio plugin is a Windows plugin which can only be installed if the plugin's certificate is trusted by the Windows System. The certificate which was used to sign the ALPS-plugin is a testing certificate, so common Windows systems will not accept it as certificate of a trusted authority. To achieve this, the certificate can be loaded into the „trusted root certificates“ folder manually. However, this might be a **potential security risk** for Windows system, and it is **highly recommended** to remove the certificate after a successful installation.

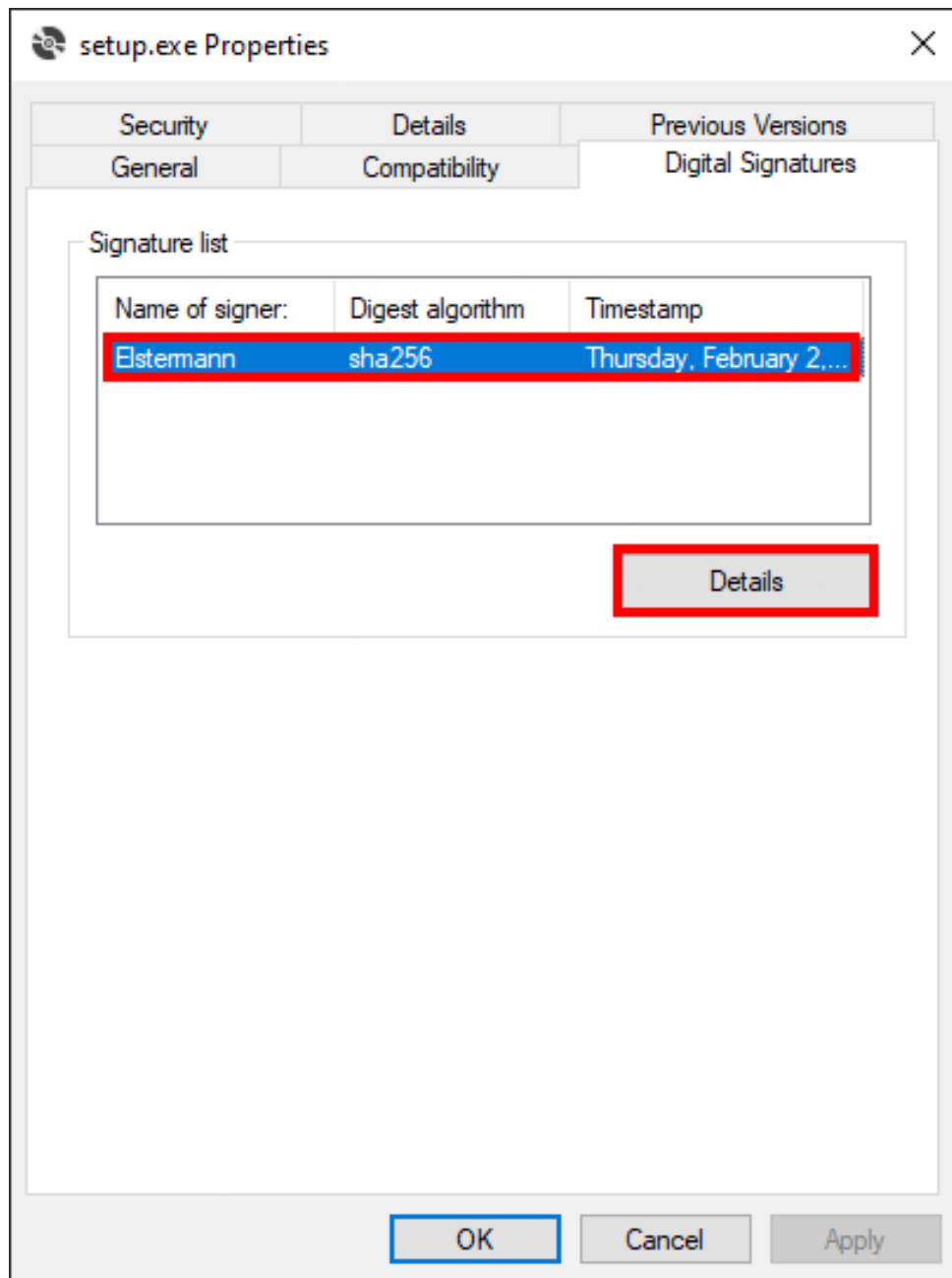
Installing the certificate

To install the certificate used for signing the plugin, move to the plugin directory and right-click onto the „setup.exe“. Choose „Properties“.

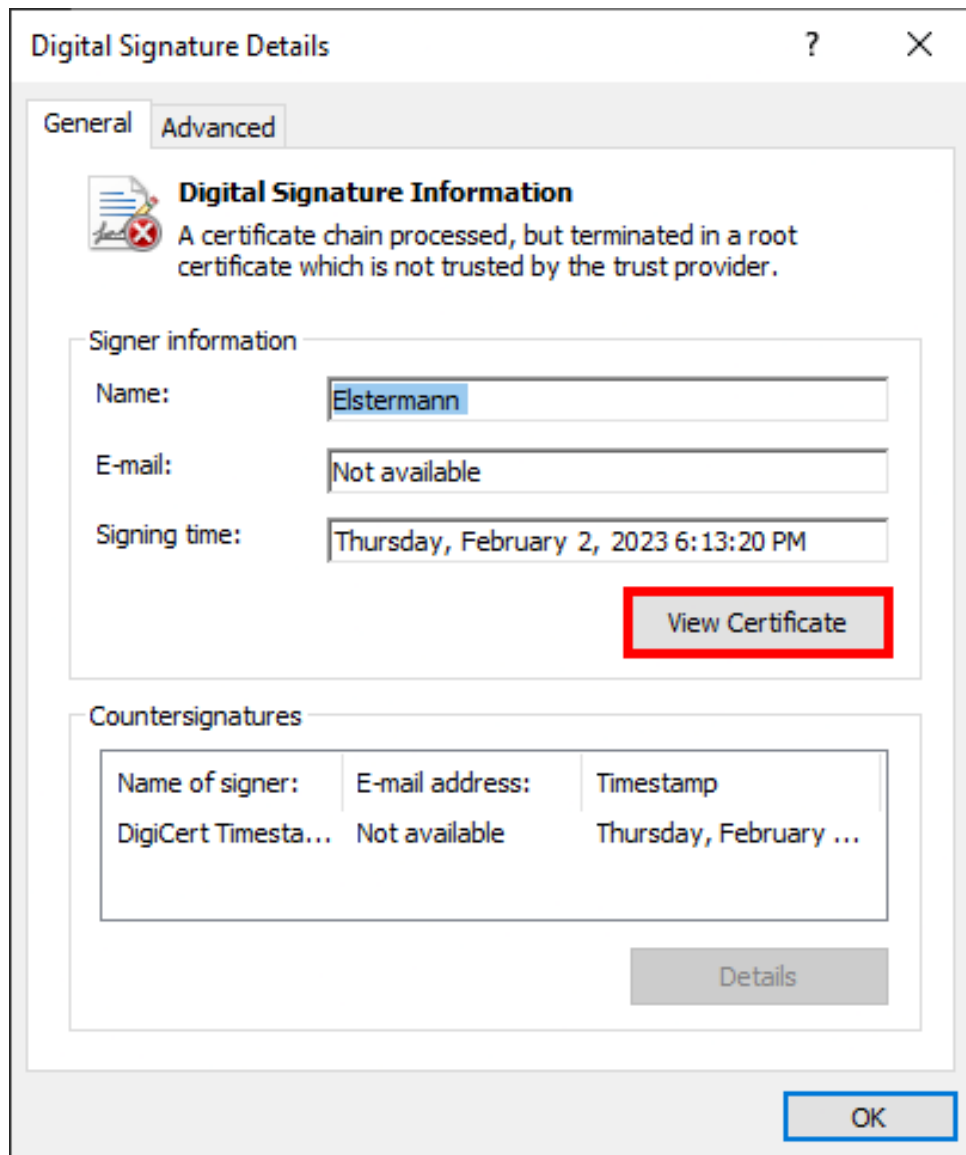


In the new window, choose the tab „Digital signatures“.

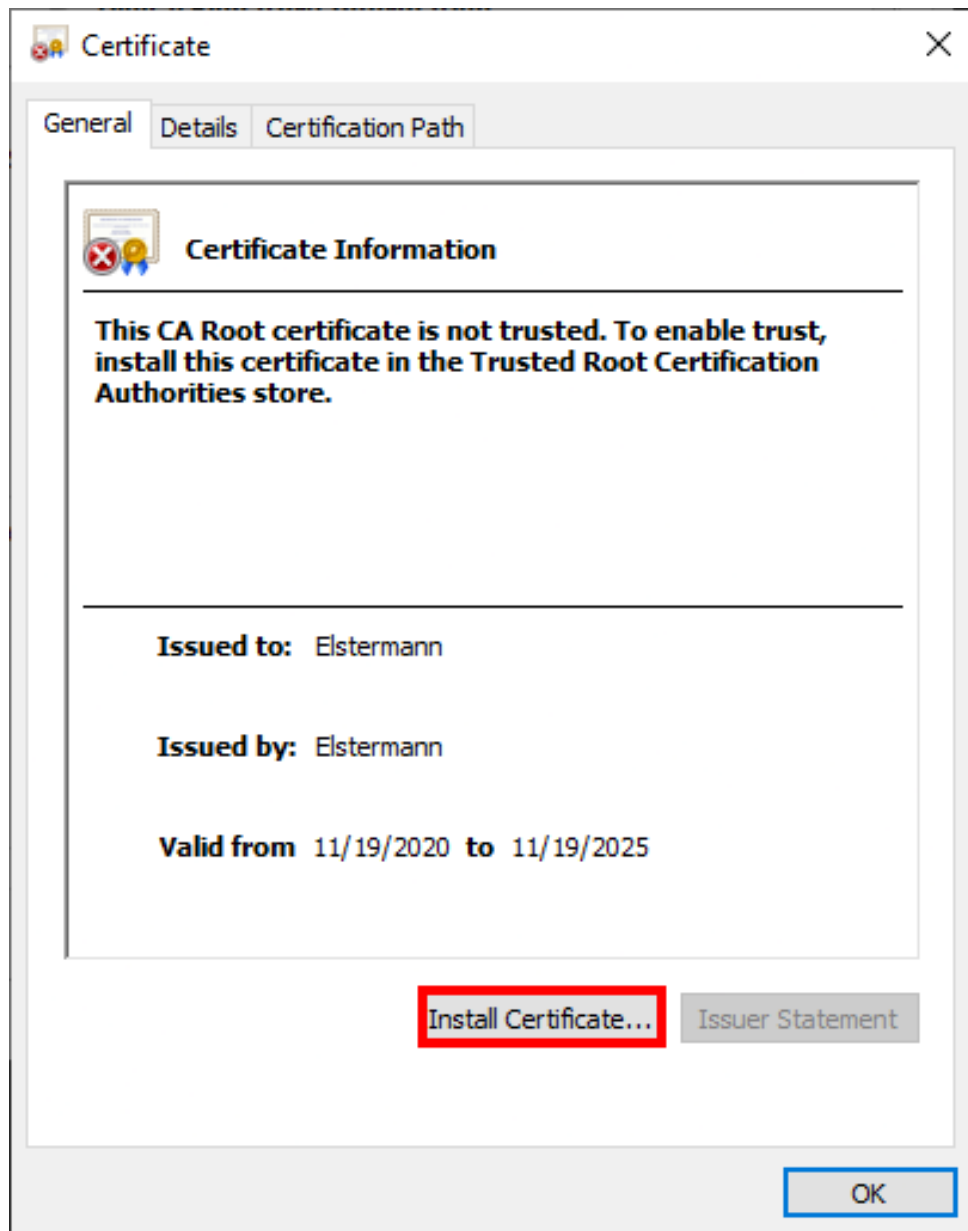
Under „Signature list“, choose the certificate and click on „Details“.



Under „Signer information“, choose „View Certificate“:



And in the next window, „Install Certificate...“:

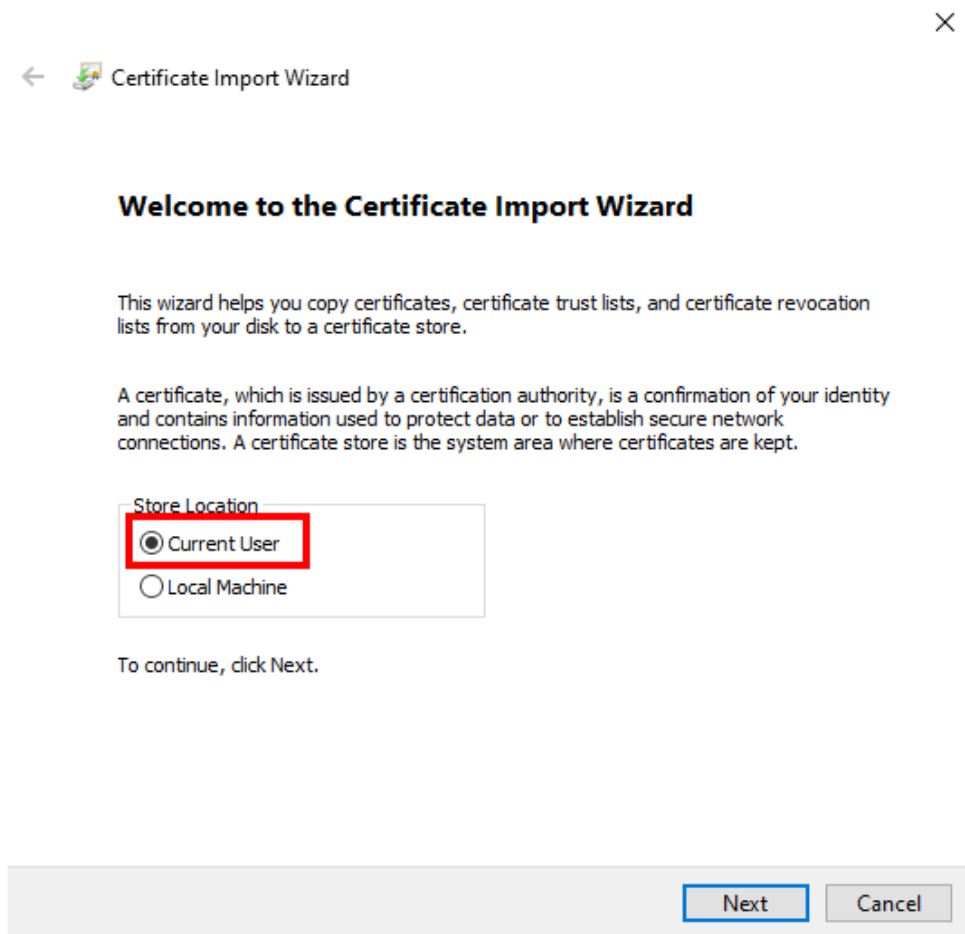


The Certificate Import Wizard will pop up.

First page:

The certificate should be installed for the current user only, as it should not affect the installing behavior of other users on the system.

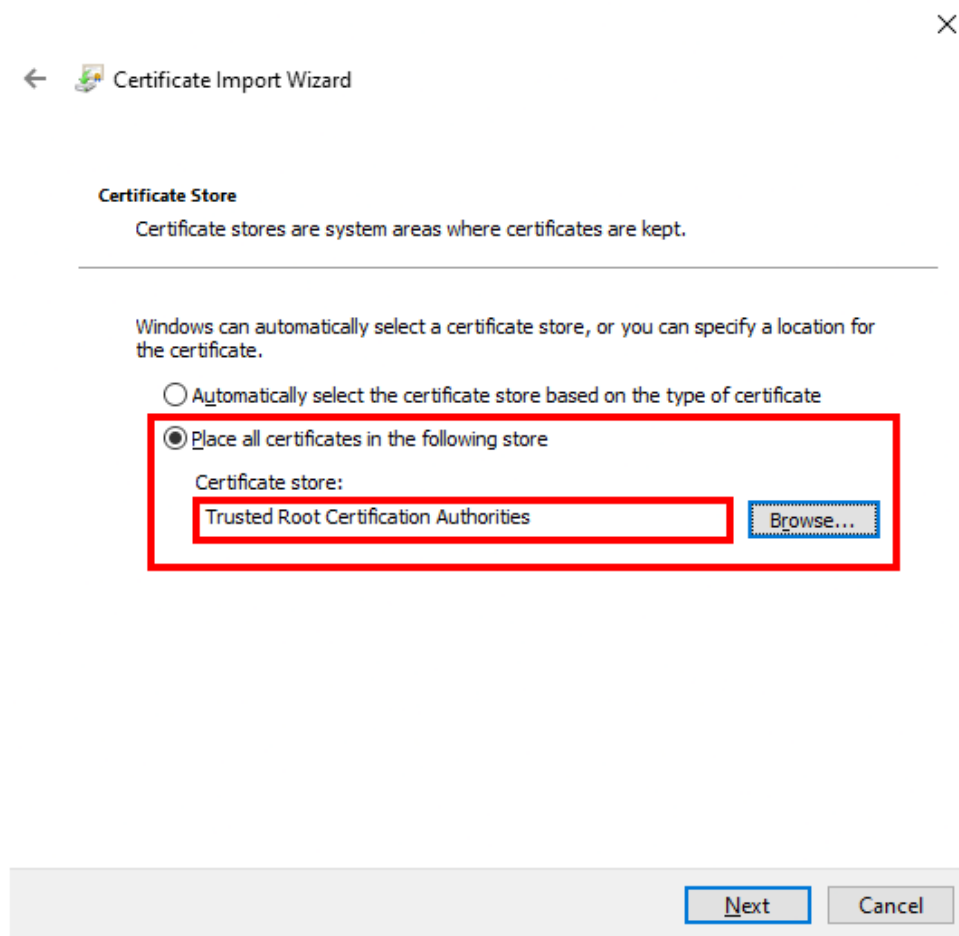
Choose „current user“ and go ahead.



Second page:

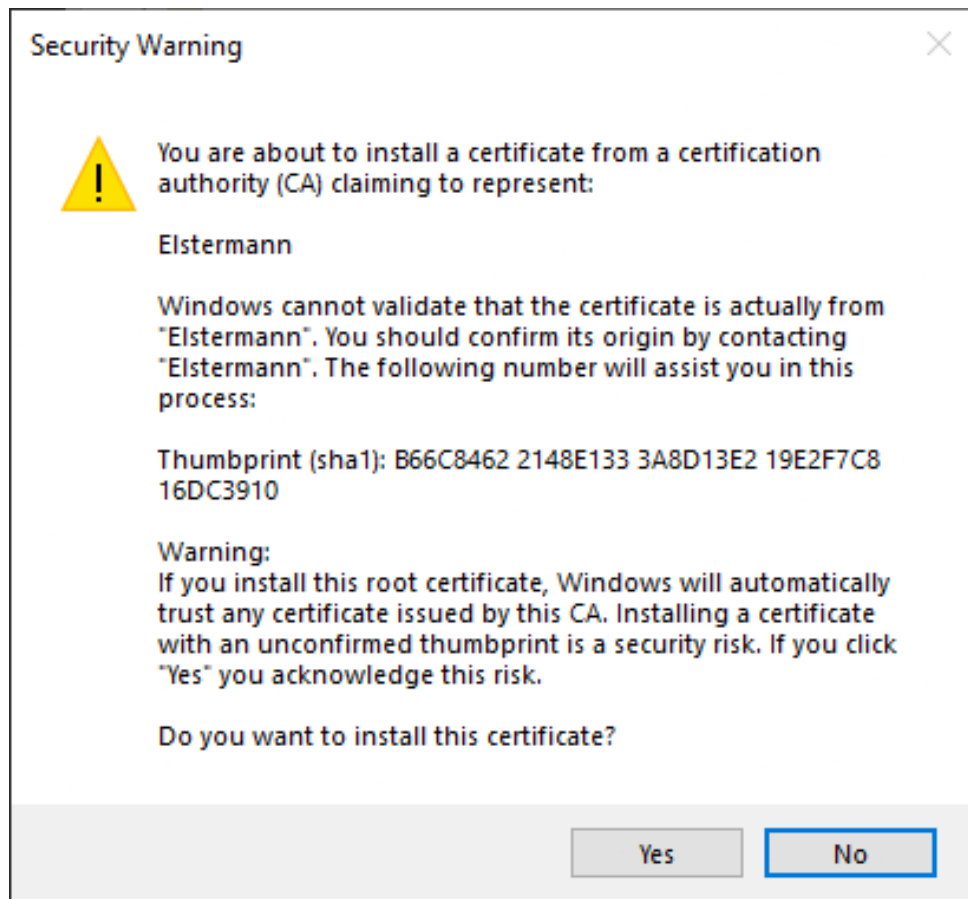
As stated before, the used certificate is only a test certificate. If it is up to Windows to decide where to store the imported certificate, windows will choose a folder where the certificate is stored, but used as trusted certificate when it comes to software installation.

To be able to install the plugin correctly, „Place all certificates in the following store:“ must be selected and the „Trusted Root Certification Authorities“ store must be chosen.

**Third page:**

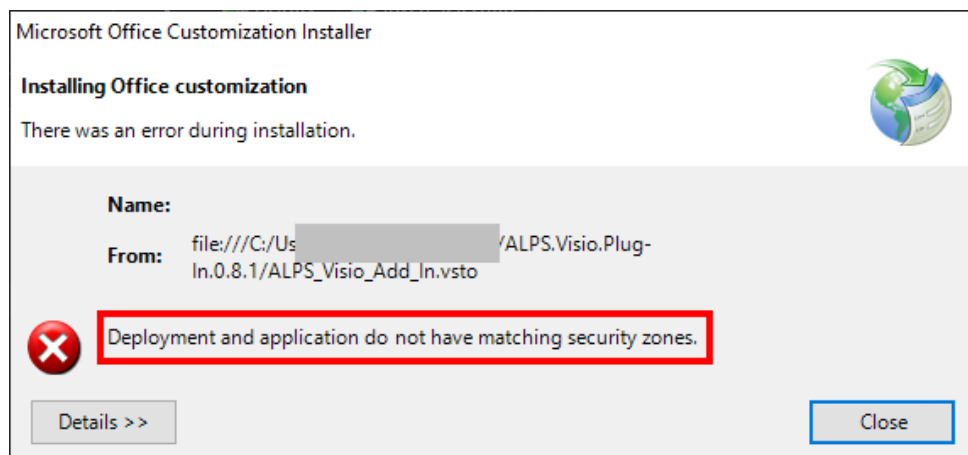
Windows will display a warning that it cannot validate this certificate, and that you install at your own risk.

Click yes and finish the installation.



Allow windows to access the Installer

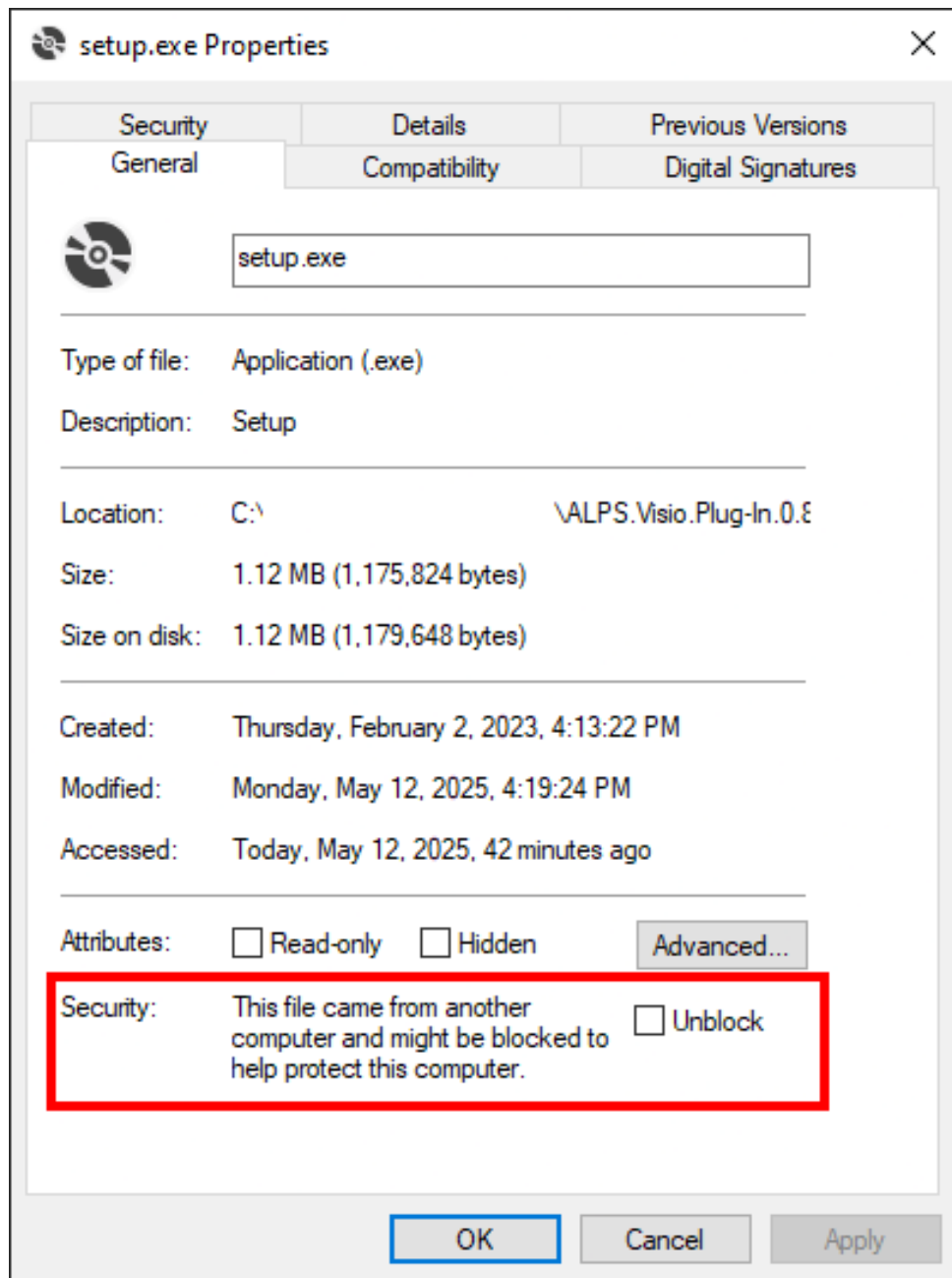
It can happen that the installation fails with the error „The deployment and application do not have matching security zones.“



If you encounter this error, you can manually unblock the files.

For **every file** (including those in subfolders):

- Right-click the file and choose „Properties“.
- If you see a message at the bottom that says „This file came from another computer and might be blocked.“, check „Unblock“, then click „Apply“ and „OK“.

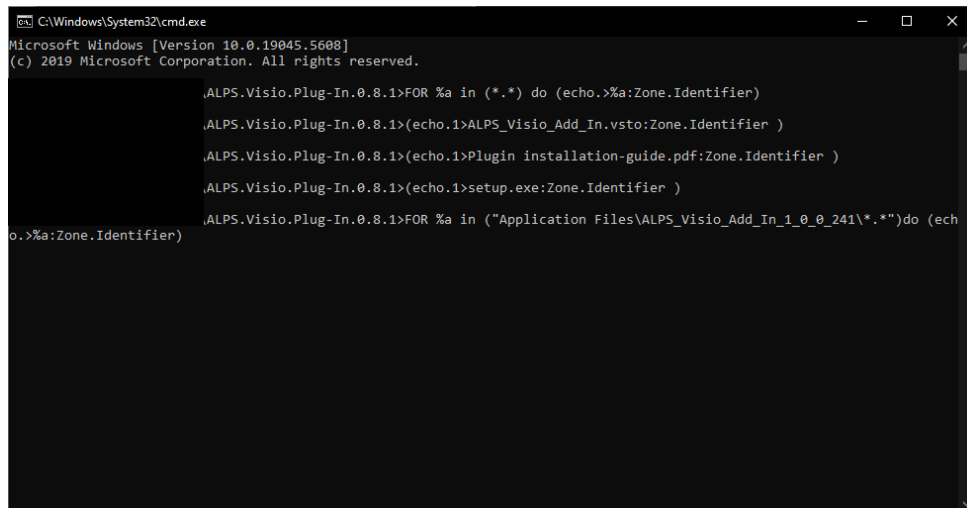


Automated Solution:

Instead of unblocking all files manually, you can also use this script to unblock all files automatically:

```
FOR %a in (*.*) do (echo.>%a:Zone.Identifier)
FOR %a in ("Application Files\ALPS_Visio_Add_In_1_0_0_241\*.*)")
do (echo.>%a:Zone.Identifier)
FOR %a in ("Application Files\ALPS_Visio_Add_In_1_0_0_242\*.*)")
do (echo.>%a:Zone.Identifier)
```

To run it, open a terminal in the „ALPS.Visio.Plug-In.0.8.1“ Folder and execute the lines of code one at a time.



```
C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.19045.5608]
(c) 2019 Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

ALPS.Visio.Plug-In.0.8.1>FOR %a in (*.*) do (echo.>%a:Zone.Identifier)
ALPS.Visio.Plug-In.0.8.1>(echo.1>ALPS_Visio_Add_In.vsto:Zone.Identifier )
ALPS.Visio.Plug-In.0.8.1>(echo.1>Plugin installation-guide.pdf:Zone.Identifier )
ALPS.Visio.Plug-In.0.8.1>(echo.1>setup.exe:Zone.Identifier )
ALPS.Visio.Plug-In.0.8.1>FOR %a in ("Application Files\ALPS_Visio_Add_In_1_0_0_241\*.*)do (ech
o.>%a:Zone.Identifier)
```

Close all the windows and install the plugin.

It is recommended to delete the certificate afterwards immediately (See next section).

Removing the installed certificate

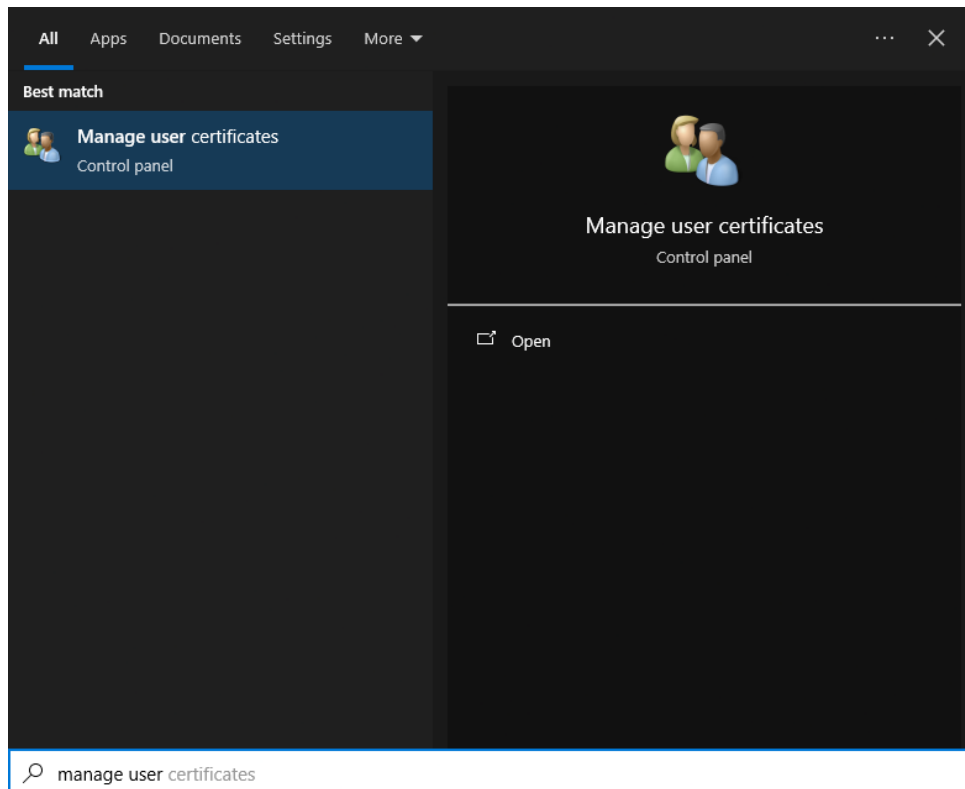
There are two possible locations for the certificate, depending on what was chosen when importing the certificate:

1. The certificate has been installed for the current user only:

Open the windows search bar and type „Manage user certificates“.

2. The certificate has been installed for the whole system:

Open the windows search bar and type „Manage computer certificates“.



In the `certmgr`-window, chose „Trusted Root Certification Authorities“, then „Certificates“ in the overview on the left. Here the installed certificate can be found and deleted.

